OF STAR POWER AND DYNASTY

If the BJP is banking heavily on film and sports personalities, the Congress finds political scions safe bets

BJP'S CELEB CIRCLE



KANGANA RANAUT
Film star • Mandi, Himachal Pradesh



ARUN GOVIL
Actor
• Meerut, Uttar Pradesh



HEMA MALINI
Film star
• Mathura, Uttar Pradesh



MANOJ TIWARI
Bhojpuri film star
• Northeast Delhi, Delhi



DINESH LAL YADAV *Actor*
• Azamgarh, Uttar Pradesh



LOCKET CHATTERJEE
Actress • Hooghly, West Bengal



DEVENDRA JHAJHARIA
Paraolympic athlete
• Churu, Rajasthan



SURESH GOPI
Malayalam film star
• Thrissur, Kerala



RAVI KISHAN
Bhojpuri star
• Gorakhpur, Uttar Pradesh

CONGRESS FAMILY CLUB



GAURAV GOGOI
Son of former Assam CM Tarun Gogoi • *Jorhat, Assam*



NAKUL NATH
Son of ex-Madhya Pradesh CM Kamal Nath • *Chhindwara, Madhya Pradesh*



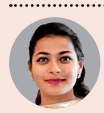
VIRENDER RAWAT
Son of former Uttarakhand CM Harish Rawat • *Haridwar, UP*



KARTI CHIDAMBARAM
Son of former Union minister P. Chidambaram's son • *Sivaganga, Tamil Nadu*



RADHAKRISHNA DODDAMANI
Son-in-law of Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, Gulbarga



PRANITI SHINDE
Daughter of former Union minister Sushil Shinde • *Solapur*



MANSOOR ALI KHAN
Son of former Union minister K. Rahman Khan • *Bangalore Central*

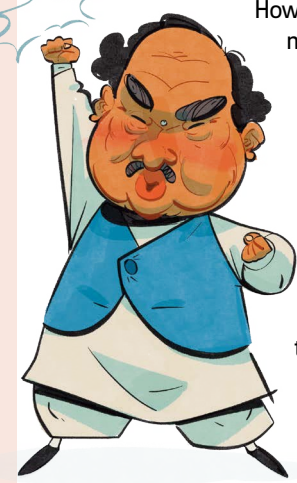
In addition, the Congress has fielded the children, grandchildren and other kin in 23 out of the 192 constituencies for which candidates have been announced. In Karnataka, three daughters and two sons of five incumbent ministers are contesting the LS polls

• *Contesting from*

KARNATAKA

Rebel Trouble

Back in 2019, the BJP set a record in Karnataka when it won 25 of the state's 28 Lok Sabha seats. Now, the BJP not only has to beat its own record, but also placate a slew of leaders who have either turned rebel or are sulking because they didn't get tickets. The most vocal among them is former Karnataka deputy CM **K.S. Eshwarappa,** who is upset that his son K.E. Kantesh wasn't named the candidate for Haveri, and Sanganna Karadi, the sitting Lok Sabha MP from Koppal who was denied a ticket. Other miffed personalities include former Union minister D.V. Sadananda Gowda. The sitting Lok Sabha MP from Bengaluru North, 71-year-old Gowda had announced his retirement a few months ago but says he was persuaded by party colleagues to reconsider.



However, when the party nominated Union MoS for agriculture Shobha Karandlaje for Bengaluru North, Gowda felt hurt. At a press conference on March 21, he said he would never quit the BJP but vowed to work towards 'cleansing' the Karnataka unit of nepotism. "Like PM Modi says '*mera desh mera parivar*', Karnataka BJP should reflect the same motto. It should not be '*mera parivar*' alone,'" Gowda said at the presser. But while he was cryptic about his accusations, Eshwarappa openly trained his guns on former CM B.S. Yediyurappa whose sons B.Y. Raghavendra and B.Y. Vijayendra are the sitting Shivamogga MP and the Karnataka BJP president, respectively. A Kuruba leader, Eshwarappa now plans to contest as a rebel from Shivamogga. ■

Kaushik Deka, Prashant Srivastava, Amitabh Srivastava, Dhaval S. Kulkarni, Ajay Sukumaran, Amarnath K. Menon and Arkamoy Datta Majumdar